

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 19

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1. Acolyte

Meaning: A devoted follower or assistant.

Tip to remember: Think of an acolyte as someone who always accompanies a leader, like a loyal helper.

Sentence: The professor's acolytes helped him organize the research conference.

2. Anoint

Meaning: To officially choose or appoint someone; originally, to apply oil in a religious ceremony.

Tip to remember: Think of a king being chosen by putting oil on his head. That is anointing.

Sentence: The party anointed her as its candidate for mayor.

3. Base

Meaning: Morally low, dishonorable, or mean.

Tip to remember: Base can mean the bottom. A base action is morally at the bottom.

Sentence: Lying to a friend for personal gain is a base act.

4. Coercion

Meaning: The use of force or threats to make someone do something.

Tip to remember: Coercion sounds like "force." If someone forces you, that is coercion.

Sentence: The workers signed the agreement under coercion.

5. Coin

Meaning: To invent or create a new word or phrase.

Tip to remember: Just as a mint creates coins, a writer can coin new words.

Sentence: The scientist coined a new term for the phenomenon.

6. Cunning

Meaning: Clever in a deceptive or tricky way.

Tip to remember: Think of a fox making a smart but dishonest plan. That is cunning.

Sentence: The cunning thief tricked everyone in the market.

7. **Discomfit**
Meaning: To make someone feel uneasy, embarrassed, or confused.
Tip to remember: Discomfit sounds like “discomfort.” If you discomfit someone, you make them uncomfortable.
Sentence: The unexpected question discomfited the speaker.
8. **Dissent**
Meaning: To disagree with an opinion, decision, or official view.
Tip to remember: Dissent sounds like “different sentiment.” It means having a different opinion.
Sentence: Several members dissented from the committee’s final decision.
9. **Distill**
Meaning: To extract the most important part of something; to purify a liquid.
Tip to remember: In chemistry, distillation extracts pure liquid. In GRE, distill means extract the main idea.
Sentence: The teacher distilled the long chapter into five key points.
10. **Dubious**
Meaning: Doubtful, uncertain, or suspicious.
Tip to remember: Dubious sounds like “doubtful.” Both mean not fully trusted.
Sentence: The data came from a dubious source.
11. **Ebullient**
Meaning: Cheerful, energetic, and full of excitement.
Tip to remember: Ebullient sounds like bubbles. Imagine happiness bubbling out of someone.
Sentence: She was ebullient after receiving her scholarship offer.
12. **Facetious**
Meaning: Treating serious issues with inappropriate humor.
Tip to remember: Think of someone making jokes when everyone else is serious. That person is being facetious.
Sentence: His facetious comment annoyed the serious audience.
13. **Fallible**
Meaning: Capable of making mistakes.
Tip to remember: Fallible sounds like “fall.” Humans can fall into error; humans are fallible.
Sentence: Even experienced researchers are fallible.
14. **Florid**
Meaning: Excessively decorated or elaborate; also reddish in complexion.
Tip to remember: Florid comes from flower-like. Too many flowers in writing make it overly decorated.
Sentence: The essay’s florid language made the main idea hard to follow.

15. **Gawky**
Meaning: Awkward and clumsy, especially in movement.
Tip to remember: Gawky sounds like awkward. A gawky person moves awkwardly.
Sentence: The gawky teenager knocked over the chair while leaving the room.
16. **Inveigle**
Meaning: To persuade someone by trickery or flattery.
Tip to remember: Think of someone saying sweet words to pull you into a trap. That is inveigling.
Sentence: The salesman tried to inveigle customers into buying unnecessary products.
17. **Jettison**
Meaning: To throw away or abandon something.
Tip to remember: A jet may jettison extra weight to fly safely.
Sentence: The team had to jettison the weak part of the proposal.
18. **Mendacity**
Meaning: Dishonesty or lying.
Tip to remember: Mendacity sounds like “men lie in city.” Remember it as the quality of lying.
Sentence: The witness was punished for his mendacity.
19. **Munificent**
Meaning: Very generous.
Tip to remember: Munificent sounds like “money magnificent.” A munificent person gives generously.
Sentence: The munificent donor funded the entire scholarship program.
20. **Naive**
Meaning: Innocent, simple, and lacking experience or judgment.
Tip to remember: Think of someone new to the world who trusts everyone easily. That person is naive.
Sentence: It was naive of him to believe every advertisement online.
21. **Noble**
Meaning: Honorable, morally good, or high in rank.
Tip to remember: Think of a noble person as someone with a high character, not just a high title.
Sentence: Helping others without expecting reward is a noble act.
22. **Parochial**
Meaning: Narrow-minded or limited in outlook.
Tip to remember: Parochial originally relates to a small parish. A parochial mind sees only its small local world.
Sentence: His parochial attitude prevented him from accepting global ideas.
23. **Pedestrian**
Meaning: Ordinary, dull, and lacking imagination.

Tip to remember: A pedestrian walks on foot; nothing special or exciting. So pedestrian can mean ordinary.

Sentence: The film had a pedestrian plot despite its famous actors.

24. **Prevaricate**

Meaning: To avoid telling the truth directly; to speak evasively.

Tip to remember: Think of someone “varying” the truth before speaking. That is prevaricating.

Sentence: The official continued to prevaricate when asked about corruption.

25. **Prime**

Meaning: Most important; first in quality; or to prepare someone for something.

Tip to remember: Prime means number one. A prime reason is the main reason.

Sentence: The prime cause of the delay was poor planning.

26. **Radical**

Meaning: Very different from tradition; extreme; relating to the root of something.

Tip to remember: Radical comes from root. A radical change affects the root of a system.

Sentence: The company proposed a radical change in its energy policy.

27. **Recrudescent**

Meaning: Becoming active again after a period of quiet.

Tip to remember: Think of a disease returning after it seemed gone. That return is recrudescent.

Sentence: The country feared a recrudescent conflict after months of peace.

28. **Temporal**

Meaning: Related to time; worldly rather than spiritual.

Tip to remember: Temporal sounds like temporary and time. It often relates to time.

Sentence: The study analyzed temporal changes in electricity demand.

29. **Transitory**

Meaning: Temporary; lasting only for a short time.

Tip to remember: Think of people in transit; they stay briefly. Transitory means short-lived.

Sentence: His sadness was transitory and soon disappeared.

30. **Viable**

Meaning: Capable of working successfully; practical and possible.

Tip to remember: Viable sounds like “able.” A viable plan is able to succeed.

Sentence: Solar energy is a viable solution for many rural communities.